



Mirror

User Guide

Dead-simple drag-and-drop file backup for macOS

Version 1.0.8

Faini Made · fainimade.com

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1 Welcome to Mirror

Mirror keeps your files safe by copying a source folder to one or more destinations (an external drive, a network volume, or any folder on your Mac). There is no complicated setup: drop a folder on each side, press **Sync now**, and watch it happen with real-time progress and clear reporting.

Mirror was built for people with large, precious libraries (photos, video, music projects, documents) who want a backup they can actually see and verify, without learning command-line tools.

Requirements

- macOS 14.0 Sonoma or later (including macOS 26 Tahoe), Apple Silicon or Intel.
- Full Disk Access is recommended so Mirror can reach every file: **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Full Disk Access**.

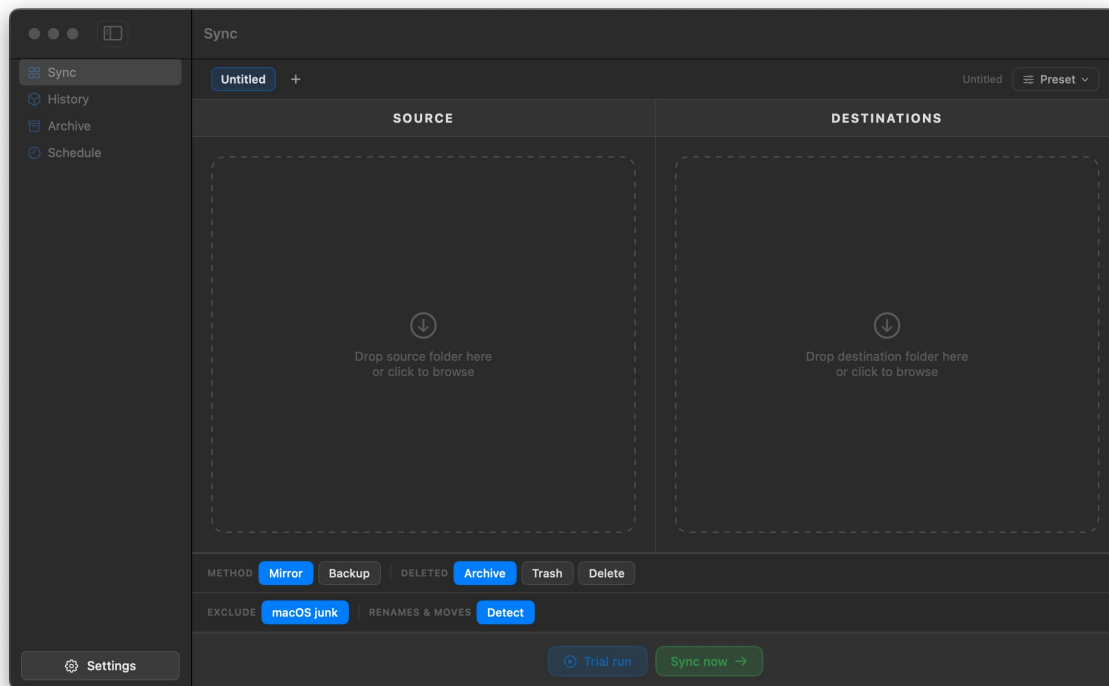
Installing

- Download the latest release and unzip it.
- Drag **Mirror.app** into your Applications folder and open it.

Privacy

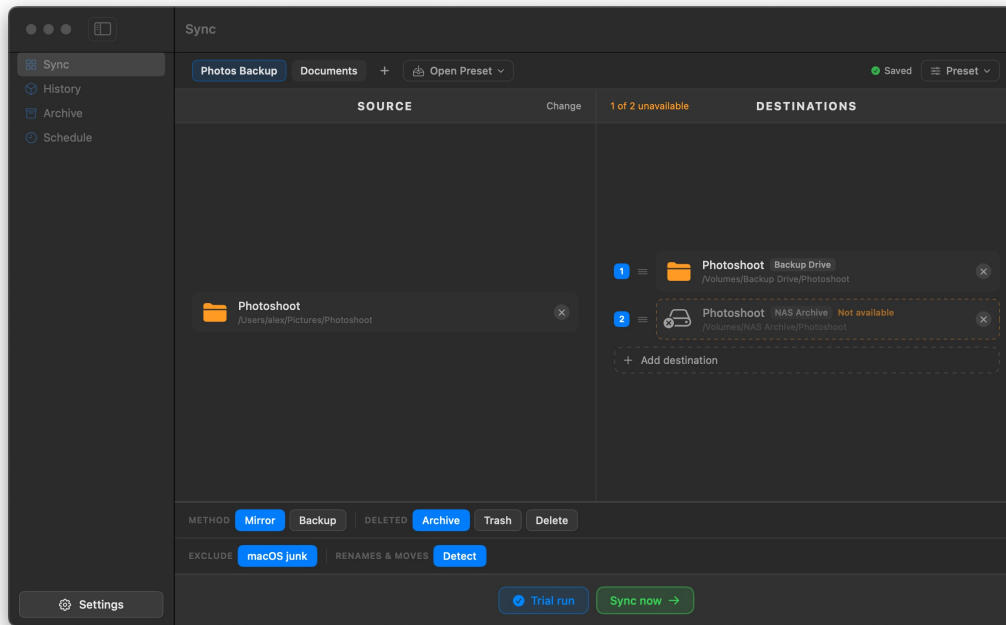
Mirror runs entirely on your Mac. Your files are never sent to any server. The only network requests are a silent update check on launch and license activation with the payment provider.

2 Your First Sync



The Sync page when you first open Mirror: two drop zones, ready to go.

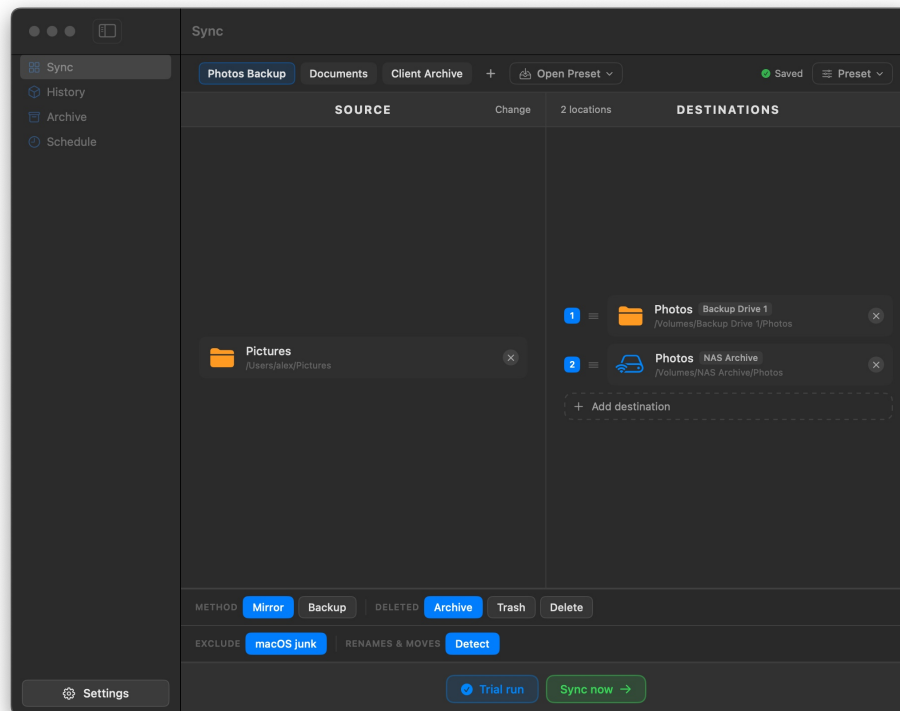
- **Add a source.** Drag the folder you want to protect into the left panel, or click it to browse.
- **Add one or more destinations.** Drag a folder on an external drive, a network volume, or your Mac into the right panel. Click **Add destination** to back up to several places at once. Mirror can copy to two or more drives at the same time to maximize throughput.
- **Choose your method** (Mirror or Backup, see the next section) and how deleted files are handled.
- **Click Trial run** to preview exactly what will happen, then **Sync now** (or press ⌘⇧) to run it.



A configured task with two destinations. Each folder shows the drive it lives on; a destination whose drive isn't connected is marked unavailable and kept in the preset.

Tabs & Presets

The Sync page is tabbed. Each tab holds its own source, destinations, and options, saved as a **sync preset**: create a tab per job, say “Photos → Backup drive” and “Documents → NAS”, and switch between them instantly. Unlike a single shared setup, switching tabs never discards unsaved edits on the one you left. Each tab remembers its own in-progress changes until you save or close it. Presets are also what schedules and automation run.



Each open tab is an independent task. Switch between them freely: edits on a tab you're not looking at are never lost.

- **+** opens a new, blank tab. The **Open Preset** menu next to it opens an already-saved preset into a new tab, instead of replacing what's already on screen.
- The **Preset** menu on the right saves the current tab (as a new preset or over the one it's already bound to) and opens the preset manager to rename or delete saved presets.
- A small dot on a tab means it has unsaved changes. A tab that's mid-sync can't be closed until the sync finishes. That's close protection, not a limitation.
- **Drag a tab** left or right to reorder the tab strip. The order is remembered the next time you open Mirror.
- By default, only one tab syncs at a time: starting a sync in one tab disables Trial Run and Sync now in the others until it's done. Turn on **Allow simultaneous syncs across tabs** in Settings to let several tabs sync at once instead. Worth knowing: multiple transfers at once share the same disk and network bandwidth, so each one may run slower than it would alone.

Drives that aren't connected

Each destination shows the drive it lives on (handy when two drives hold folders with the same name). If a destination's drive isn't plugged in, it doesn't vanish from your preset: it stays in the list marked **Not available**, and the header shows how many are offline. A trial run or sync simply skips the drives that are missing and works the ones that are connected. This means rotating backup drives, or leaving one offsite, never quietly drops it from the preset. Reconnect it and it rejoins the next run automatically.

3 Sync Methods & Deleted Files

Method	What it does	Best for
Mirror L→R	Makes the destination an exact copy of the source. New and changed files are copied; files that no longer exist in the source are removed from the destination.	A true backup that always matches the source.
Backup L→R	Additive: new and changed files are copied, but nothing is ever removed from the destination.	Collecting files over time, e.g. offloading cards or accumulating exports.

What happens to removed files (Mirror method)

- **Archive** (default): removed files are kept in a recoverable, in-app archive. Deleted doesn't mean gone.
- **Trash**: removed files go to the macOS Trash. The Trash isn't available on network volumes (NAS / SMB shares) and some non-Apple filesystems. Removals on those destinations automatically fall back to **Archive**, so nothing is ever lost or left behind.
- **Delete**: removed files are deleted immediately.

Rename & move detection

Renamed a folder of 50 GB of photos? With **Renames & Moves: Detect** enabled, Mirror recognizes that the files already exist at the destination and updates them in place instead of re-copying. A reorganization that would otherwise re-transfer the whole shoot becomes a few seconds of instant moves, and the files keep their place on the destination rather than being deleted and written again. Most backup tools can't do this at all.

Mirror never guesses. A destination file is only treated as renamed when it has gone missing from its old path on the source and matches on size and modification date, and its contents are confirmed before anything moves. Small files, and any case where several destination files share the same size, are compared byte-for-byte in full. Larger files are confirmed by size, date, and matching content sampled from the beginning, middle and end. A file simply moved to another folder under the same name is matched on size and date, exactly as Mirror decides any file is unchanged. **If a match cannot be confirmed for any reason (including a file that can't be read), Mirror copies it fresh instead.**

Tip: after reorganizing a large library, run a **Deep verify** (Section 6). It reads every byte on both sides and confirms the destination is bit-for-bit identical: certainty rather than confidence, whenever you want it.

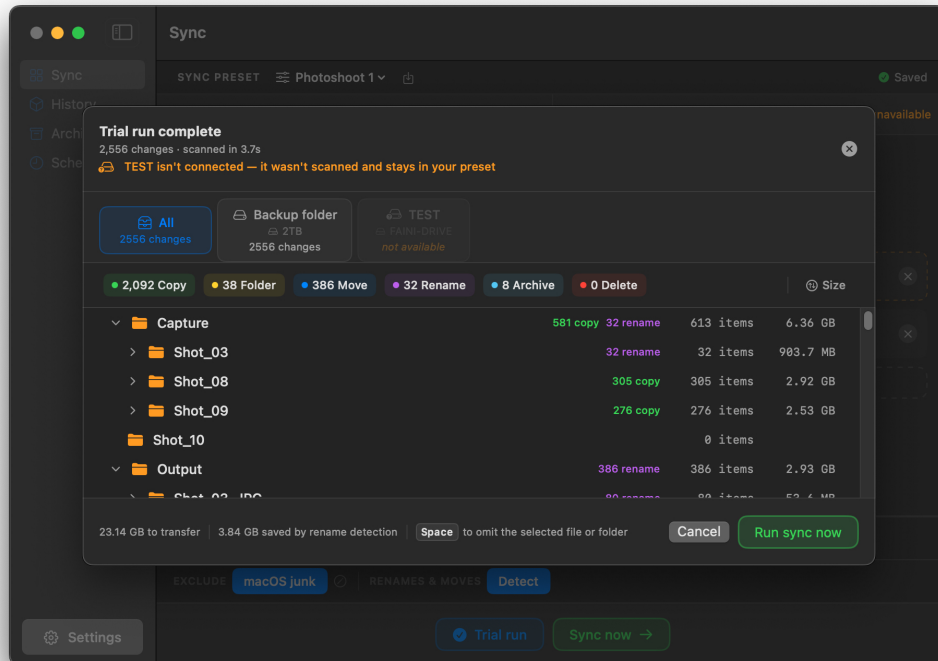
Exclusions

- macOS system junk (.DS_Store, Spotlight indexes, resource forks...) is excluded while the **macOS junk** chip is on (the default). The choice is saved with each preset.
- Transient database journal files (e.g. Capture One's .cosessiondb-journal, Lightroom's .lrcat-wal) are excluded along with it. They vanish mid-sync and can corrupt a catalog if restored next to a database they don't match.
- Add your own exclusion patterns in Settings: exact names, prefixes, or wildcards such as *.tmp.

4 Trial Run: Preview Before You Sync

A trial run scans everything and shows the complete plan: what will be copied, moved, renamed, archived, or removed, per destination, before a single file is touched. It stays fast and responsive even with tens of thousands of changes.

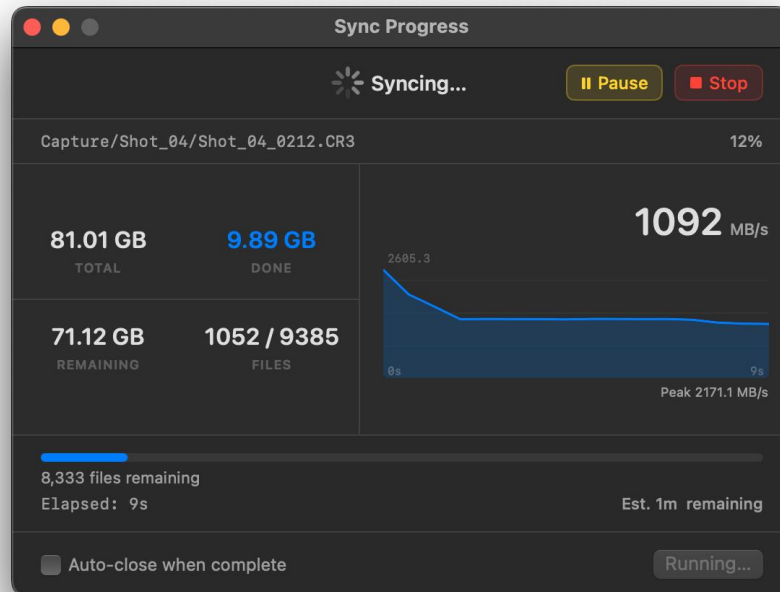
While it runs you see the current phase and live counts. A trial only reads, so you can **Cancel** at any point: nothing is left half-done. Press ⌘T any time to run one; before a first big sync (or any sync that removes files), it is the best habit you can build.



Every planned change as a drill-down folder tree: item counts and size per folder, with the total data to transfer and how much rename detection saved.

- The colored chips at the top summarize the plan: copies, new folders, moves, renames, archives, and deletions. **Click a chip to filter** the list to just that kind of change; click it again to show everything.
- Select any file or folder and press **Space** to omit it from this run.
- Syncing to multiple destinations? Each gets its own tab, labeled with the drive it lives on. **Right-click a destination's tab and choose "Ignore for this sync"** to skip that destination entirely. It's automatically included again on your next sync.
- A destination whose drive wasn't connected when the trial ran appears as a dimmed tab and is called out at the top. It wasn't scanned, and it stays in your preset for next time.
- If a sync would remove a large share of a destination (or the source scanned as empty), a warning appears right here in the preview, so surprises never wait until you press Sync.
- Happy with the plan? Click **Run sync now** straight from the preview. Curious where the time went? Hover the "scanned in ..." line for a per-phase breakdown.

5 Watching a Sync



Live transfer speed, files completed, data remaining, and time estimate.

While a sync runs you see the current file, a live speed graph with the peak rate, how much data is done and remaining, and an estimated time to finish.

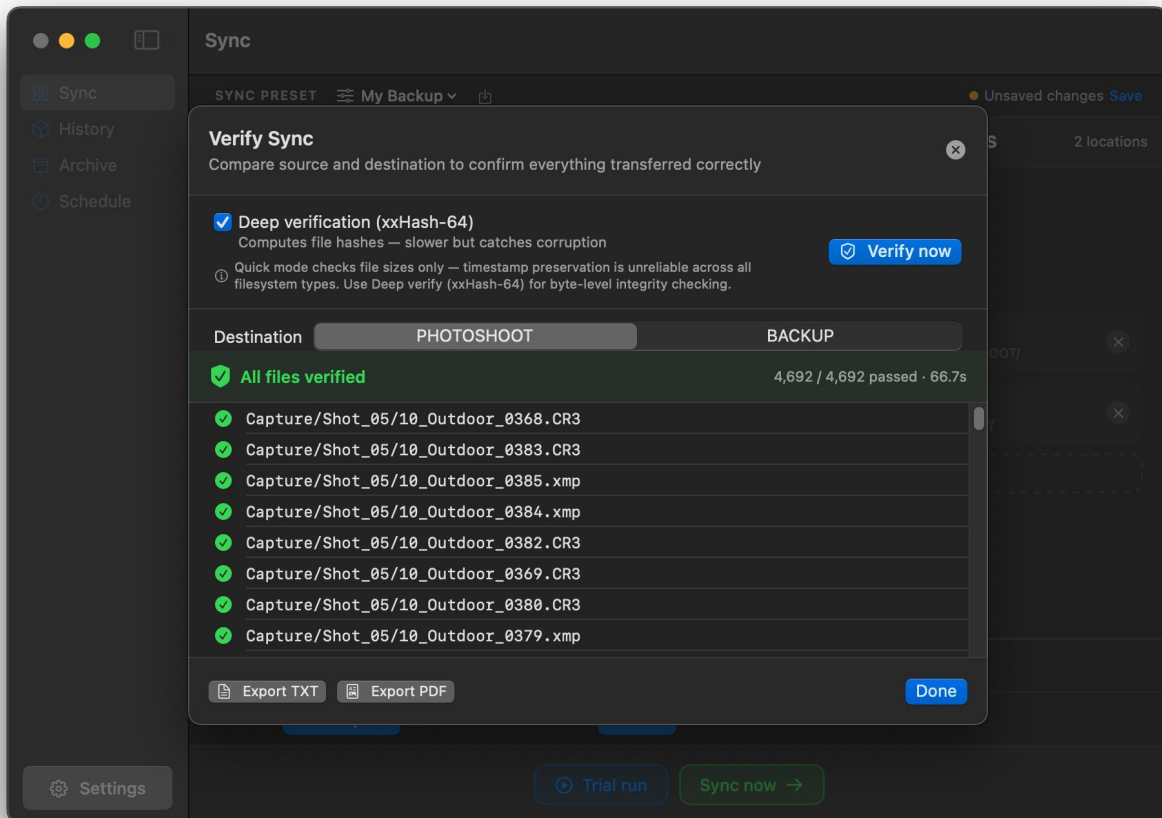
- **Pause / resume** (⌘P): pause a sync and pick it up later.
- **Stop** (⌘.): stop safely at any point. Thanks to atomic copies, a stopped sync never leaves a destination file half-written.
- Interrupted large file transfers **resume where they left off**: the existing partial file is validated against the source before Mirror appends to it.
- A notification tells you when the sync completes, with the result.
- Closed the progress window while a sync was still running? The sync itself keeps going. Closing that window never stops it. Reopen it, or stop the sync, from the Sync page: the syncing tab shows a small pie-wheel indicator: click it for Show Progress Window, Pause/Resume, and Stop, and a banner with the same controls appears right on that tab's page while you're viewing it.
- Running more than one sync at once (Section 2's **Allow simultaneous syncs across tabs**)? The progress window grows its own tabs, one per active sync, so you can check each independently. It only shows this tab strip once two or more syncs are genuinely running at the same time.

Built-in safety

- **Pre-flight check:** each destination is verified reachable and writable before anything starts, and disk space is checked so you're warned if a destination may not have room. This also catches a destination folder that's been renamed, moved, or deleted (even one that shares a drive with other destinations) instead of syncing nothing and reporting success. Syncing to several destinations and only one has a problem? The others still sync normally; only the broken one is skipped and reported.
- **Atomic copies:** a destination file is replaced only after the new copy is fully written and flushed, so a failed sync can't damage the previous version.
- **Stays awake:** while a sync (or its scan) is running, Mirror keeps your Mac from going to sleep on its own, so an overnight backup can't be cut off halfway. The display can still sleep, and a sleep or shutdown you (or a power schedule) ask for still happens.
- **Quit protection:** quitting Mirror while any sync is running (including a scheduled one) asks first, and **Stop Sync & Quit** stops it cleanly.
- **Removal safety guard:** if the source scans as empty (usually an unmounted drive) or a sync would remove a large share of a destination, Mirror stops and asks first. Scheduled runs refuse automatically and notify you instead. Renamed or moved files are kept in place and aren't counted as removals, so reorganizing your library never looks like a mass deletion.

6 Verification: Trust Your Backup

A backup you haven't verified is a hope, not a backup. After any sync, Mirror can compare the destination against the source and prove they match.



Deep verification: every file checked, per-destination results, exportable report.

- **Quick:** compares file sizes. Fast, catches missing or truncated files.
- **Deep (xxHash-64):** computes a hash of every file on both sides: a bit-for-bit integrity check, optimized to stay fast on large photo and video libraries.

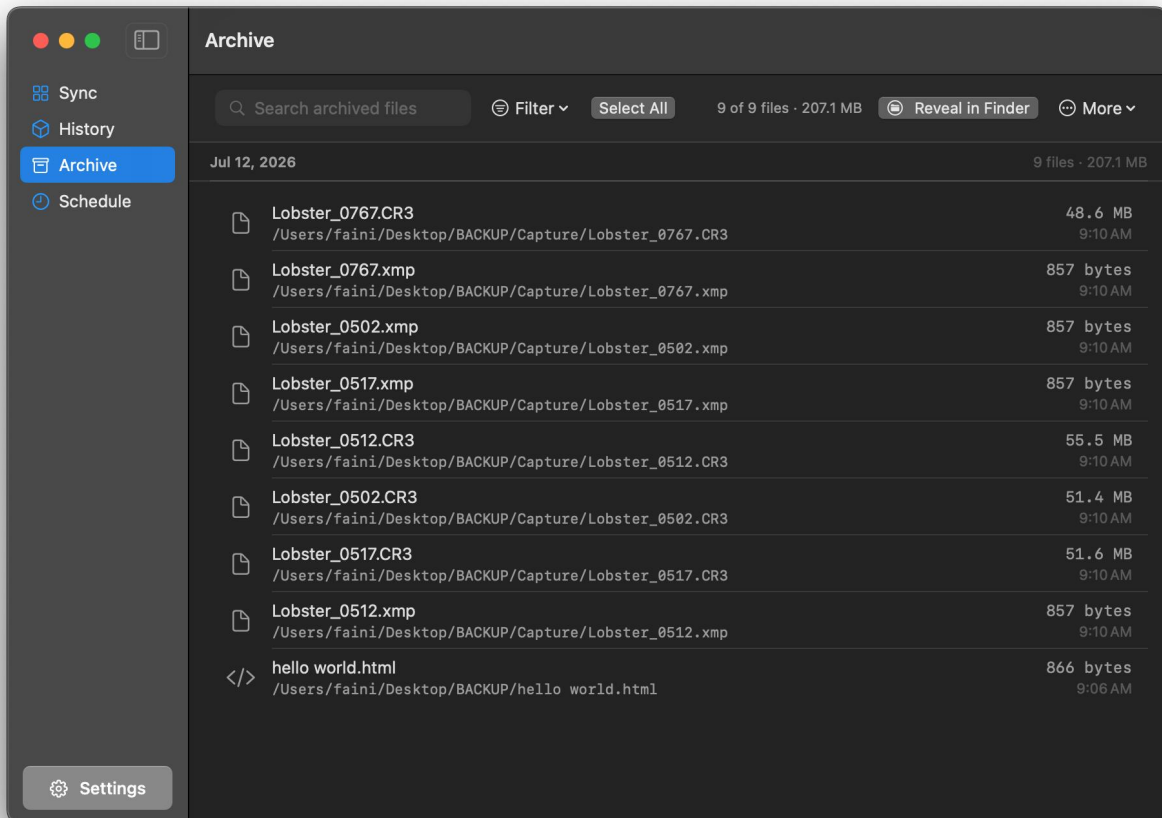
Run verification manually after a sync, or turn on auto-verify after every sync in Settings. Results are recorded in History and can be exported as TXT or PDF (handy when a client or your own peace of mind wants proof).

Verifying a Backup L→R task? Backup mode never removes anything from a destination, so files that exist only there are expected. Verification checks that every source file arrived intact, but doesn't flag destination-only files as “extra”; they're kept by design, not an error.

Why not timestamps? Timestamp preservation is unreliable across filesystems (network volumes especially), so Mirror's deep verify relies on content hashes instead.

7 The Archive

With the **Archive** option selected, files removed by a Mirror sync aren't gone: they're kept in a browsable, searchable archive inside the app.

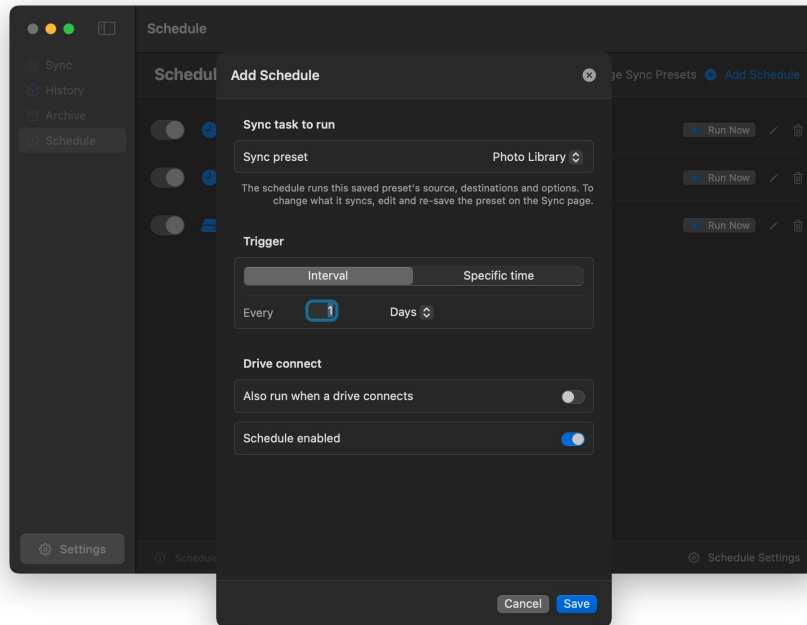


The Archive: search, filter, select, and restore, grouped by the sync that archived them.

- Browse and search everything a sync has ever archived, grouped by date.
- Restore a single file or many at once: the original folder structure is preserved.
- Syncing to multiple destinations? Browse each destination's archive separately or all together.
- **Reveal in Finder** jumps straight to the archived file on disk.

8 Scheduling

Backups you have to remember aren't backups. Schedules run a **saved preset** automatically, and you can create several independent schedules. Because each one is tied to a preset, it always backs up the same folders no matter which tabs are open or how they're ordered. To schedule a sync, set it up on the Sync page and choose **Preset** → **Save as Preset...** first.



Adding a schedule: pick a preset, then an interval, a specific time, or a drive-connect trigger.

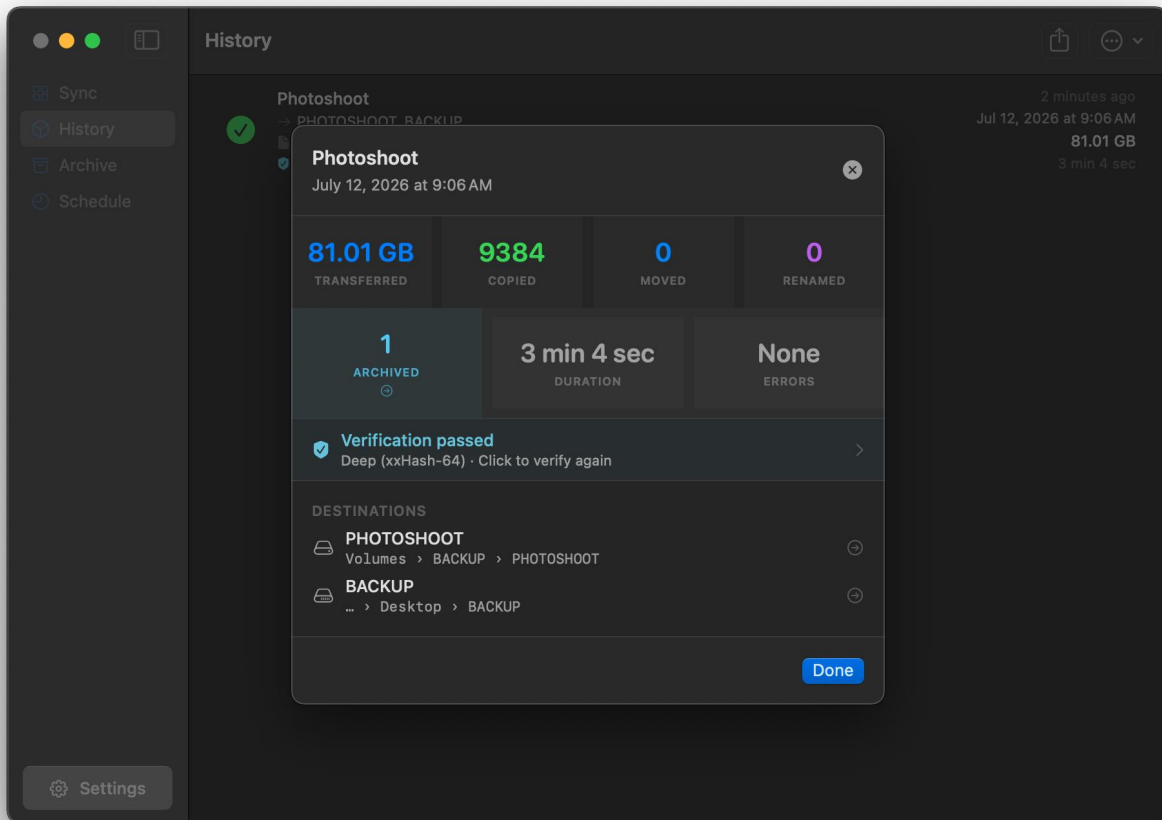
- **Interval:** every N minutes or hours.
- **Specific time:** at set times on the days you choose.
- **Drive connect:** run automatically the moment a backup drive is plugged in.
- **Where it runs:** a scheduled sync runs in its preset's own tab on the Sync page, opening one in the background if that preset isn't already open (or has unsaved edits), so it never replaces what you're working on in another tab.
- **Older “Current task” schedules:** earlier versions could schedule “Current task”, whatever was on the Sync page at the time. Those schedules are now marked **Choose a preset** and don't run until you edit them and pick one; when one comes due, Mirror sends a notification instead of skipping it silently. The same goes for a schedule whose preset was deleted (marked **Preset missing**).
- **Run Now:** every schedule also has its own **Run Now** button, so you can fire it immediately, on demand, regardless of its trigger or enabled state (handy for testing a new schedule or running an occasional backup without waiting for its timer). The button is disabled, not just quietly ineffective, whenever running it would conflict with a sync already in progress: that schedule already running, any sync in progress when multiple scheduled syncs aren't allowed at once, or the concurrent-syncs limit already reached. So Run Now never interrupts or races with something already happening.

- **Run in the background:** the scheduler's app-wide options live behind the **Schedule Settings** button at the bottom of the Schedules page. Turn on **Run scheduled syncs in the background** there and scheduled syncs run without opening the progress window or interrupting what you're working on. You still get a completion notification, and live progress is on the Sync page whenever you open Mirror. While a background sync runs, Mirror's Dock icon shows a live percentage badge (or a count of how many are running, if you've turned on multiple at once), so there's a visible sign of progress even with no window open.
- **Run several at once:** by default, scheduled syncs run one at a time; a second due schedule waits its turn. Turn on **Allow multiple scheduled syncs to run at once** in **Schedule Settings** to let different schedules run concurrently instead: choose how many at once (2 to 6), and each running schedule gets its own live progress row right on the Schedules page. A schedule never runs concurrently with itself, and a manual **Sync Now** is never limited by this.
- **Keep Mirror running:** in **Settings** → **General**, turn on **Keep Mirror running when the window is closed** so closing the window leaves Mirror in the Dock and schedules keep firing. Enabling it also switches scheduled syncs to background mode automatically; click the Dock icon to reopen the window.

Each schedule has its own Run Now button, and multiple scheduled syncs can run at once with a configurable maximum, off by default.

9 History & Reports

Every sync is recorded: file counts, transfer sizes, duration, verification results, and any errors, categorized so you can see at a glance what happened.



A sync record: totals, duration, verification status, and each destination.

- Stopped syncs show the specific reason: “Drive disconnected”, “Disk full”, “Stopped manually”.
- A sync appears in History as soon as it starts, marked **In progress**, and its counts update as it runs. If Mirror was quit or the Mac shut down before it finished, the entry is marked **Interrupted** the next time Mirror opens, with how far it got, so an unfinished backup never goes unrecorded.
- Click a record's verification row to re-verify that sync at any time.
- Export any record as plain text or PDF.
- History can clean itself up automatically by age or by count (Settings → History).

10 Keyboard Shortcuts & Automation

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
⌘T	Run trial sync
⌘⇧	Run sync now
Space	Omit the selected file or folder (Trial run window)
⌘P	Pause / resume a running sync
⌘.	Stop a running sync
⌘,	Open settings
⌘W	Close window

URL scheme

Mirror can be driven by anything that can open a URL: Shortcuts, Stream Deck, Keyboard Maestro, Alfred, Raycast, a shell script...

A sync or trial started by URL runs in that preset's own tab (opening it if needed), exactly like a scheduled sync, and waits its turn under the same one-sync-at-a-time rule: if another sync is running, you get a message (a notification for `silent=1`) instead of a second sync starting.

URL	Action
<code>mirror://sync?preset=Name</code>	Run sync for a preset
<code>mirror://sync?preset=Name&silent=1</code>	Sync without opening the window
<code>mirror://trial?preset=Name</code>	Run a trial sync
<code>mirror://stop</code>	Stop every running sync
<code>mirror://stop?preset=Name</code>	Stop one preset's sync
<code>mirror://status</code>	Copy status JSON to the clipboard (add <code>?preset=Name</code> for one preset)
<code>mirror://open</code>	Bring Mirror to the front

11 Good to Know: Limits by Design

Mirror is deliberately focused. Knowing what it doesn't do is as useful as knowing what it does:

- **One-way sync only.** Mirror copies from source to destinations. It is not a two-way/bidirectional sync tool. Changes made directly in a destination will be overwritten or removed on the next Mirror sync.
- **Folder backup, not a system cloner.** Mirror backs up folders you choose. It doesn't create bootable clones of macOS and isn't a replacement for Time Machine's versioned system snapshots; it complements them.
- **No cloud storage.** Destinations are folders your Mac can see: local disks, external drives, and mounted network volumes. (A cloud folder that syncs via a local folder, like Dropbox or Drive, works fine.)
- **Network volumes must be mounted.** Mirror can't mount a server share by itself: connect to it in Finder first (or set it to auto-mount at login).
- **The Trash needs volume support.** Most network volumes have no Trash, so the Trash option can't apply there. Mirror automatically archives those removals instead (see section 3). Restore them any time from the Archive.
- **Schedules run while Mirror is running.** They can't fire while it's fully quit, and a run missed while Mirror was closed is skipped unless you turn on **Run missed schedules when Mirror opens** in **Schedule Settings** (bottom of the Schedules page). Closing the window normally quits Mirror; turn on **Keep Mirror running when the window is closed** (Settings) to leave it in the Dock so schedules keep firing with the window shut.
- **Version history lives in the Archive.** Mirror keeps files that were removed or replaced (Archive option), but it isn't a full point-in-time versioning system with browsable snapshots per date.

12 Troubleshooting

Symptom	What's happening & what to do
"Destination not reachable" before sync	The pre-flight check couldn't see or write to the destination: its drive may not be connected, or the folder itself may have been renamed, moved, or deleted since you set it up (even on a drive that's still connected). Make sure the drive is connected (or the network share is mounted in Finder), the folder still exists where you expect it, and it isn't read-only, then run the sync again.
Sync stopped: "Drive disconnected" or "Disk full"	Mirror stopped safely. Nothing was left half-written. Reconnect the drive or free up space and re-run the sync; large files resume from where they left off.
Mirror asks before removing files (safety guard)	The source scanned as empty or the sync would remove a large share of the destination. This usually means a source drive isn't mounted or you picked the wrong folder. Check the source in Finder before confirming; only confirm if the removals are genuinely intended.
Chose Trash, but files were archived	That destination doesn't support the Trash (most network volumes don't). Mirror archives removals there instead of leaving them behind or deleting them. Restore them any time from the Archive section.
A scheduled run didn't happen	Mirror must be running for schedules to fire. A run missed while Mirror was closed is skipped by default; turn on "Run missed schedules when Mirror opens" in Schedule Settings to catch them up on the next launch. A schedule marked "Choose a preset" or "Preset missing" won't run until you edit it and pick a saved preset. If a run was refused, the notification and History entry explain why (usually the safety guard or an unreachable drive).
History shows a sync as "Interrupted"	That sync started but never finished: Mirror was quit or crashed, or the Mac was shut down or put to sleep partway through. The entry shows roughly how far it got. Run the sync again; files already copied are skipped, and large files resume where they left off.
Can't open a second Mirror window, or a second copy of the app	This is by design, not a bug: Mirror runs as a single instance with a single window, so there's always one clear place to see what's syncing rather than juggling several windows or copies at once. Opening Mirror again (Dock icon, Spotlight, <code>mirror://open</code>) brings the existing window to the front instead of opening a new one. Want to work on more than one backup task at once instead? That's what tabs on the Sync page are for. See Section 2.
Closed the Sync Progress window: can't tell if a sync is still running	Closing that window never stops a sync; it keeps going in the background. On the Sync page, the syncing tab shows a small pie-wheel indicator: click it for Show Progress Window, Pause/Resume, and Stop, or select that tab to see the same controls in a banner.
Mirror window keeps following me between Spaces / desktops	Mirror leaves its window on whichever Space (desktop) you put it on and no longer pulls it to the front Space when you reopen it. If a window still follows you across Spaces, turn on System Settings → Desktop & Dock → Mission Control → "When switching to an application, switch to a Space with open windows for the application". That macOS setting is off by default and affects every app. To pin Mirror to one desktop, right-click its Dock icon → Options → Assign To → This Desktop.

“Permission denied” or files skipped	Grant Mirror Full Disk Access: System Settings → Privacy & Security → Full Disk Access → enable Mirror, then relaunch it.
Verification reports mismatches	Run the sync again, then Deep verify. If the same files keep failing, the destination disk may be failing; try another drive and check it with Disk Utility.
Errors on catalog/journal files (e.g. Lightroom, Capture One)	These transient journal files are excluded by default. If you removed that exclusion, re-enable it in Settings: the files vanish mid-sync and are unsafe to restore anyway.
Update check or license activation fails	Both need a brief internet connection. Day-to-day use is fully offline; try again when you’re online.

Still stuck? The History entry for a sync lists every error, categorized, and can be exported . Include it when you get in touch via fainimade.com.

13 Trial, Licensing & Support

Free trial

Mirror includes a 7-day free trial with full functionality: every feature in this guide, no limitations. During the trial, a bar along the bottom of the window shows how many days are left, with **Enter License** and **Buy Now** buttons.

Buying a license

- Purchase at **software.fainimade.com**: your license key arrives by email.
- To activate: **Settings** → **About** → **Enter License Key**, and paste your key.
- **One license, two Macs**: each license includes 2 seats.
- **Good for life across all 1.x releases**: every 1.x update is free.
- Moving to a new Mac? **Settings** → **About** → **Deactivate This Mac** frees a seat, then activate on the new machine.
- Activation and deactivation need a brief internet connection; day-to-day use works fully offline.

Support

For support or licensing questions, get in touch via fainimade.com.

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